



YOU ARE **32 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

50 days to go

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### YOUR BABY TODAY

This image may show the start of a smile. Your baby will often be smiling inside, sticking their tongue out, and making all sorts of faces. They may also still be experiencing hiccups that may be something that you are now becoming aware of.

**“The days and nights fly by with a newborn, so it’s a good idea to start thinking about child care well before you need it.”**

It may seem impossible to believe that you should be considering child care before your baby is even born, but it can be useful to think through the options while you have the time. There are two main types of child care: in and out of your home. In the first case, you can have a live-in or live-out nanny or mother’s helper, an au pair (which may be acceptable if you work from home, for example, and can supervise), or perhaps a family member or friend who is prepared to come to your house to take care of your baby. If you choose outside child care, there are a number of options including day-care centers, relatives or babysitters in their homes, or on-the-job day care. Before you set your heart on one particular type of care, it’s a good idea to investigate the costs and the availability in your area. You may want to pay a visit to some of the nurseries or other facilities close to you, just to get a feel for what’s available, and establish now what you do and don’t want. Secondly, remember that good-quality child-care facilities and babysitters are usually in demand, and, even if you aren’t entirely sure when you will be going back to work, it’s probably a good idea to put your baby’s name (or last name, at least!) down for a few, to give you options when the time comes.

### CALCIUM INTAKE

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**Calcium transferred** across the placenta to your baby is essential for the healthy development of their skeleton and teeth, as well as for their blood.

Your body adapts to optimize the amount of calcium your baby receives. If your diet is, or has been, low in calcium, it will be mobilized from your bones to go to your baby—so your baby won’t have a calcium deficiency, but you might.

Vitamin D is needed to help your body metabolize calcium, so take a 600–800 IU daily supplement. Also make sure you eat plenty of calcium-rich foods, especially dairy foods, since these are particularly good for helping to prevent loss of bone mass. Just one glass of milk provides 300 mg of the 800 mg calcium you need each day. See good sources of [calcium](#).

### FOCUS ON PARTNERS

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